



LME CROCHET PATTERN - AMIGURUMI

ELLIE

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

Ellie is a curious little fawn who loves flower meadows, butterflies and the small secrets of the forest. She is crocheted in soft natural colours, with big expressive eyes and a removable bow. A fully original LME design, finished size approx. 18 to 20 cm sitting. Medium difficulty.

By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIP: Read through the whole pattern once before you start. Crochet a small gauge swatch first, so Ellie comes out just the right firmness and shape.

ABOUT ELLIE

THE STORY

Ellie is a curious little fawn who loves flower meadows, butterflies and the small secrets of the forest. She is calm, caring and brave, and quickly becomes a safe cuddle friend for small children. Ellie belongs to the LME Baby Collection "Woodland Dreams", a set of soft woodland friends in the same natural colours and with the same look.

STYLE AND LOOK

Ellie is a fully original LME design, not a copy or close imitation of Bambi or other known characters. This is how you recognise the style across the whole LME Baby Collection:

- **Scandinavian and Montessori-inspired** Calm, natural colours and simple, clean shapes.
- **Bigger head proportions** A big round head and cute, rounded proportions, never exaggerated.
- **Big expressive eyes** Big, soft eyes with long lashes give Ellie a warm, gentle look.
- **Premium handmade feel** Firm amigurumi tension, neat seams and a precise fit between the pieces.

Ellie is NOT Disney-style, not realistic, not anime, and not exaggerated in shape.

SIZE AND MATERIALS

FINISHED SIZE

Approx. 18 to 20 cm tall, sitting.

YARN

Bystrikk Merino and DROPS Cotton Merino (or similar) give a soft, firm amigurumi surface.

Colour	For	Amount
Bystrikk Merino, brown (main colour)	head, body, arms, ears, tail	approx. 2 skeins
Bystrikk Merino, dark brown	hooves at the base of the legs	small amount
DROPS Cotton Merino, off-white	face patch, belly panel, ear insides, tail underside, spots	approx. 1 skein
Leftover, powder pink	the bow (removable)	small amount
Black embroidery thread	nose and mouth (if embroidered, see the face page)	small amount

Alternative yarn: any soft cotton/acrylic-blend DK/aran-weight yarn (e.g. Hobbii Amigo, Rico Ricorumi, Paintbox Simply DK) works well for amigurumi, as long as you crochet tightly enough that the stuffing does not show. Always check your gauge.

HOOK AND TOOLS

- Crochet hook 3.5 mm or 4 mm · depending on how tightly you crochet
- Polyester fibrefill · clean, washable toy stuffing
- Two 16 mm safety eyes (version A), or black embroidery thread (version B) · see the face page
- Yarn needle with a blunt tip · for all sewing
- Stitch marker · one, or a loop of contrast yarn
- Needle and strong sewing thread · for attaching ears, the bow tab and spots
- Measuring tape and scissors

GAUGE AND GLOSSARY

GAUGE, THE IMPORTANT KEY

Approx. 18 sc x 20 rounds = 10 x 10 cm, crocheted TIGHTLY (amigurumi tension) on a 3.5 mm hook. If you crochet looser than this, the stuffing shows through the stitches and Ellie turns out soft and floppy instead of neat and firm. Crochet a small swatch first: 12 sc in a magic ring, increase around for 4 rounds, and check that the stitches close snugly around your finger.

GLOSSARY AND ABBREVIATIONS

Short	Means
ch	chain stitch
sc	single crochet (UK: double crochet)
sl st	slip stitch
magic ring	an adjustable starting ring that closes with no hole in the middle
inc	increase: 2 sc in the same stitch. Adds one stitch.
dec	decrease: insert the hook through two stitches at once and crochet them together as one sc. Removes one stitch.
st(s)	stitch(es)
rnd	round, a full round worked in a spiral
()	the number in brackets at the end of the row is the total stitch count for that round
...	repeat what is between the stars as many times as stated afterwards

All of Ellie is crocheted in a spiral of single crochet, without joining the rounds and without turning the work, except for the bow which is worked back and forth in rows. Place a stitch marker in the first stitch of each piece and move it up every round, so you always know where the round begins.

HOW ELLIE IS BUILT

Ellie is crocheted in nine pieces, which are all sewn together at the very end. No pieces are glued, and everything is sewn securely so that nothing comes loose. Get to know the pieces before you begin:

1. The head

big and round, with a light face patch

2. The muzzle

a small oval muzzle in the middle of the face patch

3. The ears (x2)

big, round, with a light inside

4. The body

a small oval body with a belly panel

5. The arms (x2)

small and soft, short

6. The legs (x2)

small, firm, with a dark hoof

7. The tail

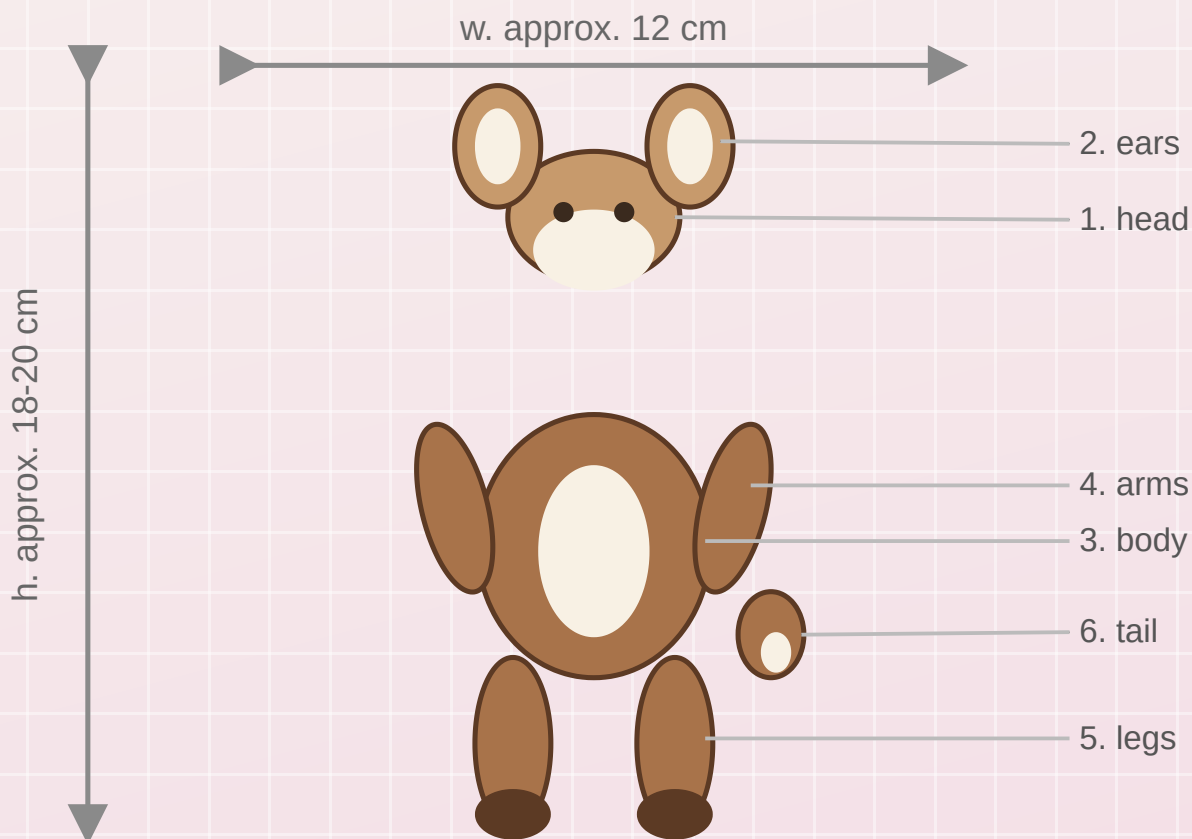
short and soft, cream underside

8. The back spots

small cream spots, any number you like

9. The bow

removable, powder pink



Size sketch: Ellie sitting, approx. 18 to 20 cm tall and approx. 12 cm wide across the arms.

PART 1: THE HEAD

The head is crocheted in a spiral, from the top down, in brown. It starts narrow, increases out to its widest point in the middle, stays even for a while, then decreases back down towards the neck.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30
6	(4 sc, inc) x 6	36
7	(5 sc, inc) x 6	42
8	(6 sc, inc) x 6	48
9 to 16	48 sc, 8 rounds with no increases	48
17	(6 sc, dec) x 6	42
18	42 sc	42
19	(5 sc, dec) x 6	36
20	36 sc	36
21	(4 sc, dec) x 6 - start stuffing firmly and evenly from here	30
22	(3 sc, dec) x 6	24
23	(2 sc, dec) x 6	18
24	(1 sc, dec) x 6 - stuff the last bit	12
25	dec x 6	6

Do not cut the yarn. Gently gather it through the last 6 stitches and use that same yarn tail to attach the head to the body later (see assembly). The head should now be firm and round, approx. 9 cm in diameter.

PART 2: THE FACE PATCH AND MUZZLE

The light coloured 'mask' around Ellie's muzzle is a separate flat piece sewn onto the head. The small round muzzle is then sewn on top of that, right in the middle of the patch. Both pieces are crocheted in cream.

THE FACE PATCH (CREAM)

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30
6	(4 sc, inc) x 6	36

Fasten off, leaving a tail of approx. 20 cm. Do not stuff this piece, it should lie flat. Sew it flat onto the lower half of the head, from just above the middle down towards the chin, so it forms a light oval "mask".

THE MUZZLE (CREAM)

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4 to 5	18 sc, 2 rounds	18

Fasten off, leaving a tail of approx. 20 cm. Tuck a small bit of stuffing into the muzzle so it is gently domed, and sew it in place in the lower centre of the face patch.

PART 3: THE EARS (MAKE 2)

Each ear is crocheted in two layers: a big circle in brown (the outside) and a smaller circle in cream (the inside), which are sewn together. Crochet two of each.

THE OUTSIDE (BROWN) - MAKE 2

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30
6	30 sc	30

THE INSIDE (CREAM) - MAKE 2

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24

Cut both pieces, leaving a tail of approx. 20 cm. Do not stuff the ears, they should be flat. Place the cream circle in the middle of the brown one and sew it on with running stitch, leaving an even brown rim showing. Fold each ear gently front to back (a small pinch at the bottom) before sewing it to the head, this gives the soft, slightly bent shape.

Sew the ears on top of the head, one on each side, slightly behind the centre, with enough space between them so they stand up and are visible from the front.

THE FACE

The face is what brings Ellie to life. Take your time here, and try pinning things in place with safety pins before you sew or fasten anything.

EYES - TWO VERSIONS

Version A: safety eyes (age 3+)

Use 16 mm safety eyes. Insert them approx. 2 cm apart, at the top edge of the face patch, roughly in the middle of the head vertically. Push the backing washer firmly into place BEFORE you finish stuffing the head, so the eye cannot be pulled back out from the inside.

Version B: embroidered eyes (baby-friendly, 0+)

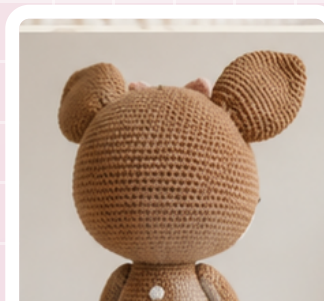
For the very youngest: embroider the eyes instead, with black embroidery thread. Sew a small, dense oval or circle (satin stitch) at each eye point, leaving a tiny unstitched highlight near the top of the eye for a lively look. Fasten the threads extra securely inside the head.



LME CROCHET

NOSE, MOUTH, LASHES AND CHEEKS

- **Nose:** Embroider a small black triangle or oval nose above the centre of the muzzle, in dense satin stitch.
- **Mouth:** From the base of the nose, embroider a small "Y" or smile shape downward and out to each side in backstitch, using black thread.
- **Lashes:** Embroider 2 to 3 short, curved stitches with black thread above the outer corner of each eye, to give Ellie her soft, slightly dreamy look.
- **Cheeks:** Crochet two small flat circles in powder pink (6 sc in a magic ring, fasten off), and sew them lightly onto the cheeks below each eye. An alternative is to brush a little dry blusher onto the cheeks, but that colour can fade in the wash.



PART 4: THE BODY

The body is small and oval, just big enough for Ellie to sit steadily. Crocheted in brown, with a separate cream belly panel sewn onto the front.

THE BODY (BROWN)

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30
6	(4 sc, inc) x 6	36
7 to 14	36 sc, 8 rounds with no increases	36
15	(4 sc, dec) x 6	30
16	30 sc	30
17	(3 sc, dec) x 6 - stuff the body evenly and firmly now	24
18	24 sc	24
19	(2 sc, dec) x 6	18

Do not cut the yarn. Check that the body is filled evenly and firmly (especially at the bottom, so Ellie sits steadily), then use that same yarn tail to attach the head on top of the body (see assembly).

PART 4: THE BODY

THE BELLY PANEL (CREAM)

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5	(3 sc, inc) x 6	30

Fasten off. Do not stuff this piece, it should lie flat. Sew the belly panel flat onto the front of the body, from just below the neck and downward.

PART 5: THE ARMS AND LEGS

The arms are short and soft. The legs are a little longer and stuffed firmer, so Ellie sits and stands well. Each foot has a small dark brown 'hoof' at the base.

THE ARMS (BROWN) - MAKE 2

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring	6
2	inc x 6	12
3 to 10	12 sc, 8 rounds	12

Cut the yarn, leaving a tail of approx. 20 cm. Stuff lightly and loosely, the arms should be soft and a little floppy, not stiff.

THE LEGS (DARK BROWN + BROWN) - MAKE 2

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring, dark brown (the hoof)	6
2	6 sc dark brown	6
3	switch to main brown: inc x 6	12
4	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
5 to 13	18 sc, 9 rounds	18

Cut the yarn, leaving a tail of approx. 20 cm. Stuff firmly, especially at the bottom, so the legs can support the body when Ellie is sitting.

PART 6: THE TAIL AND BACK SPOTS

THE TAIL

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring, cream	6
2	switch to main brown: inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	18 sc	18
5	(1 sc, dec) x 6	12

Cut the yarn, leaving a tail of approx. 20 cm. Stuff lightly. Sew the tail onto the back, right above where the legs will sit, with the cream round facing down and slightly backward.

THE BACK SPOTS (CREAM, ANY NUMBER)

Crochet 5 to 9 small circles in cream: 6 sc in a magic ring, fasten off (for the smallest spots), or 6 sc in a magic ring + 1 round of inc x 6 = 12 sts (for slightly bigger spots). Cut with a long tail, do not stuff them. Sew the spots scattered across the upper back, with more spots higher up and fewer further down, just like a real fawn.

PART 7: THE BOW (REMOVABLE)

The bow is removable, so an adult can swap it for a different colour, or take it off during washing. It is crocheted back and forth, not in a spiral. Use powder pink (or any colour you like).

TWO MATCHING RECTANGLES

Row	Description	Sts
1	12 ch + 1 turning chain	12
2 to 8	sc in each stitch back across, 7 rows	12

Crochet two matching rectangles like this. Cut with a long tail on both.

SEW INTO A BOW

- 1 Lay the two rectangles on top of each other and fold both short ends in towards the middle, so it forms a small bow shape.
- 2 Wrap a short length of yarn tightly around the centre a few times, to cinch the bow together there.
- 3 Crochet a narrow strip (approx. 6 ch + 1 row of sc) and sew it around the waist of the bow, over the knot, for a neat finish.
- 4 Crochet a small loop (a chain of approx. 8 ch, closed into a ring with a slip stitch) and sew it securely onto the back of the bow.

THE ATTACHMENT TAB ON THE HEAD

Crochet a small flat "tab": 6 sc in a magic ring, fasten off. Sew it firmly onto the head between the ears, with plenty of stitches so it cannot come loose. Slip the bow's loop over this tab, like a loop over a toggle button. The bow now stays firmly in place during play, but an adult can lift the loop off and swap the bow when needed. NEVER sew loose small parts (beads, ribbon, metal clasps) directly onto the bow, that is not safe for small children.

ASSEMBLY

Now all the pieces become Ellie. Use safety pins to test the placement first, then sew everything firmly at the end. Everything is sewn on with tight running stitch or backstitch and strong, twisted thread, nothing is glued.

- 1 Sew the belly panel onto the front of the body (if not already done).
- 2 Sew the legs onto the bottom of the body, approx. 1 to 2 cm apart, so Ellie sits steadily.
- 3 Sew the arms onto each side of the body, a little below where the neck will be.
- 4 Sew the face patch and muzzle onto the head (if not already done), and add the eyes, nose, mouth, lashes and cheeks (see the face page).
- 5 Sew the head onto the body, centred over the neck. Check that the head faces forward before you sew it on completely.
- 6 Sew the ears onto the head, one on each side (see the ears page for placement).
- 7 Sew the tail onto the back, right above the legs.
- 8 Sew the back spots on, scattered across the upper back.
- 9 Crochet and attach the bow tab between the ears, then slip the bow on last.

FINISHING, SAFETY AND CARE

FINISHING TOUCHES

- Fasten every loose end securely on the inside of the pieces: weave it back and forth through a few stitches with the yarn needle, then trim what is left.
- Check over every seam. If any stitches are loose or there are gaps, sew over them with a few extra stitches.
- Carefully trim away any loose fuzz from the yarn with small scissors.

SAFETY

- No parts are glued, everything is sewn securely with strong thread. Double-check the seams on the eyes, nose, ears, arms and legs, these are the spots that get the most tugging during play.
- If you use safety eyes (version A), Ellie is intended for children aged 3 and up, since small parts can loosen over time with heavy use. For the very youngest, use version B with embroidered eyes instead.
- Always check old seams and re-sew them if you see signs of wear. Retire Ellie if stuffing starts to come out, or if a piece comes loose and cannot be sewn safely back on.
- Never let a small child play unsupervised with small parts such as the bow tab. The bow is meant to be swapped by an adult, not removed by the child.

WASHING AND CARE

Hand wash in lukewarm water with a little mild soap, or machine wash at 30 degrees in a wash bag. Gently press out the water in a towel, do not wring. Reshape Ellie neatly and lay her flat to dry, pushing a little extra stuffing back into place while she is still damp.

CONGRATULATIONS, ELLIE IS DONE!

Now you have crocheted your very own Ellie, the little fawn. Feel free to show her off in #lmebabycollection, I love seeing what you make!

THE REST OF THE LME BABY COLLECTION

Ellie is the first in "Woodland Dreams", a whole little collection in the same look, yarn choice and colour palette:

- Pip, the little hedgehog
- Felix, the little fox
- Molly, the little lamb
- Luna, the little bunny
- Oliver, the little bear
- Ellie's pacifier clip
- Pip's pacifier clip
- Felix's pacifier clip
- Molly's pacifier clip
- Luna's pacifier clip
- Oliver's pacifier clip
- Ellie's rattle
- Pip's rattle
- Felix's rattle
- Molly's rattle
- Luna's rattle
- Oliver's rattle
- Ellie's stroller toy
- Pip's stroller toy
- Felix's stroller toy
- Molly's stroller toy
- Luna's stroller toy
- Oliver's stroller toy
- Ellie's ballerina shoes
- Ellie's activity toy

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